Animating CSS

CSS is a powerful tool, and one of the powers it has is that many CSS properties can be animated. You can animate the color, position, and even the shape of a CSS element. This gives you the ability to make your site more dynamic and interesting by just adding and removing CSS classes.

Three somewhat overlapping CSS concepts allow you to animate the display of existing elements with CSS:

- transform is a CSS property that instantly changes the values of other CSS properties by changing the size, position, or orientation of the element being drawn.

- transition specifies a CSS property and a duration. When the specified property changes, the change happens gradually over the specified duration of time, rather than instantaneously.

- animation is a more general form of a transition that allows you to specify multiple stopping points between the start and end value as well as more complex timing and repeating behavior.

To show how these properties work, we're going to go back to our original Show/Hide button on the schedule page of our app and turn it into something that looks more like the triangle widget in the macOS finder—both the button and the text will gradually change their positions.

First, we need the image. I've put a raw image in app/ assets/images/chevron-right.svg. (Technically, I copied the SVG chevron-right image from http://heroicons.com and made the fill color gold so that it would show against both the black and white backgrounds of the button.)

Then, we need to adjust our view to display that image instead of the "Show" or "Hide" text. Here's a temporary change I've made to the button in the app/views/favorites/_list.html.erb file (in a moment, we'll make a more permanent